

8. Determiners

Definition and Introduction

Determiners are words placed before nouns to clarify what the noun refers to. They help to show quantity, possession, definiteness, or which one is meant. A determiner can limit the meaning of a noun by answering questions like “which?”, “how many?”, or “whose?”. Using correct determiners improves accuracy in writing and speaking. In exams, determiners are often tested through blanks and error correction. Common determiners include articles, demonstratives, possessives, quantifiers, and numbers.

This book is very interesting.

I have some homework to finish.

Her bag is on the table.

Many students were absent today.

The sky looks cloudy.

Pre Determiners

Pre-determiners come before the main determiner and add extra meaning about quantity or emphasis. They are used with other determiners like articles, possessives, or demonstratives. Common pre-determiners include all, both, half, double, and such. They help to highlight how much of something is being talked about. Correct placement of pre-determiners is important for grammatical order in sentences.

All the students stood up.

Both my sisters live in Pune.

Half the milk is finished.

Double the amount was paid.

Such a beautiful day!

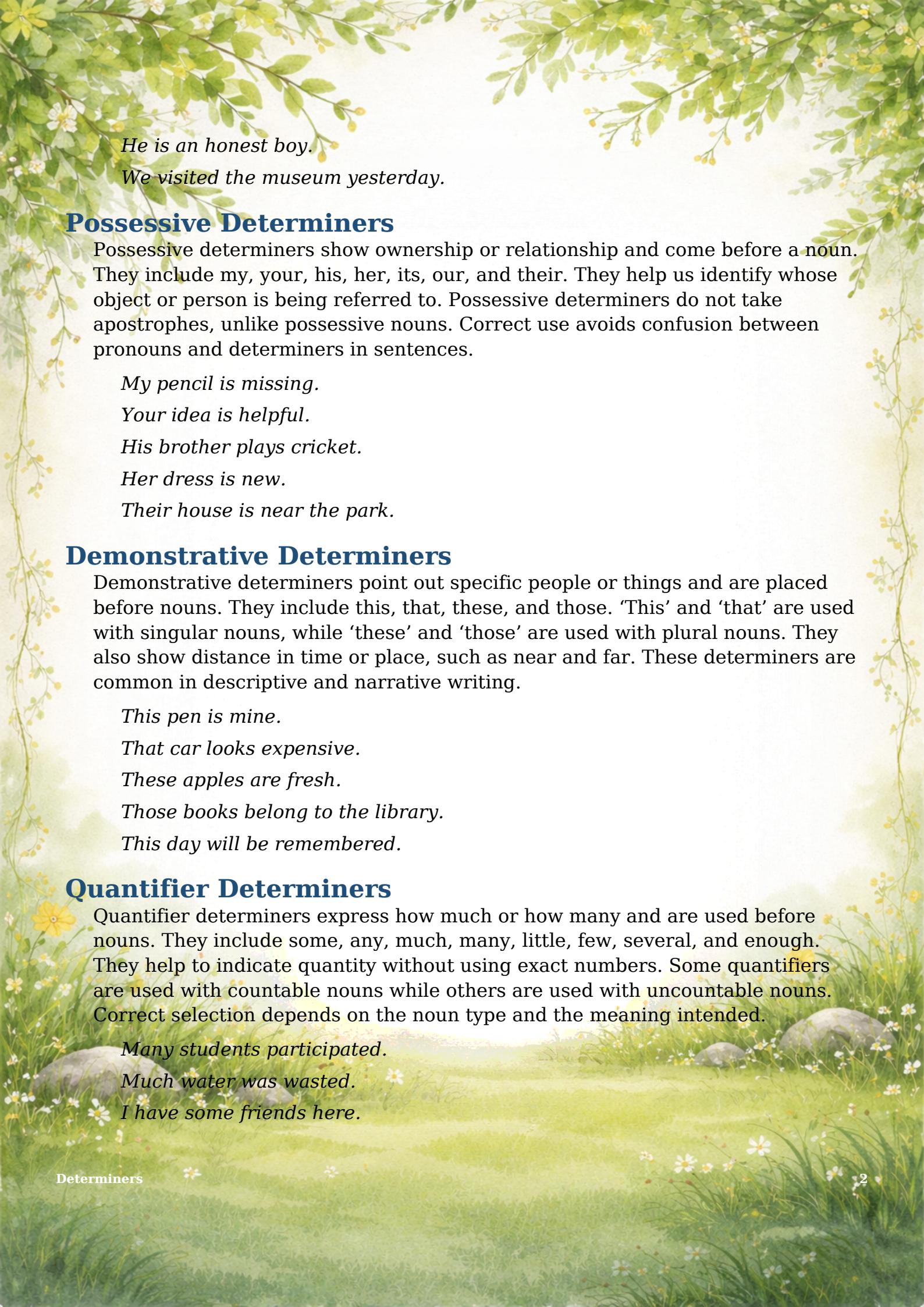
Article Determiners

Articles are determiners used before nouns to show whether we are talking about something specific or general. ‘A’ and ‘an’ are indefinite articles used for non-specific singular nouns. ‘The’ is the definite article used for a particular person, place, or thing. Choosing between ‘a’ and ‘an’ depends on sound, not spelling. Articles are frequently tested in CBSE exams through fill-ups and editing tasks.

I saw a dog in the street.

She bought an umbrella.

The teacher explained the rule.



He is an honest boy.

We visited the museum yesterday.

Possessive Determiners

Possessive determiners show ownership or relationship and come before a noun. They include my, your, his, her, its, our, and their. They help us identify whose object or person is being referred to. Possessive determiners do not take apostrophes, unlike possessive nouns. Correct use avoids confusion between pronouns and determiners in sentences.

My pencil is missing.

Your idea is helpful.

His brother plays cricket.

Her dress is new.

Their house is near the park.

Demonstrative Determiners

Demonstrative determiners point out specific people or things and are placed before nouns. They include this, that, these, and those. 'This' and 'that' are used with singular nouns, while 'these' and 'those' are used with plural nouns. They also show distance in time or place, such as near and far. These determiners are common in descriptive and narrative writing.

This pen is mine.

That car looks expensive.

These apples are fresh.

Those books belong to the library.

This day will be remembered.

Quantifier Determiners

Quantifier determiners express how much or how many and are used before nouns. They include some, any, much, many, little, few, several, and enough. They help to indicate quantity without using exact numbers. Some quantifiers are used with countable nouns while others are used with uncountable nouns. Correct selection depends on the noun type and the meaning intended.

Many students participated.

Much water was wasted.

I have some friends here.

Do you have any money?

There is enough time.

Cardinal and Ordinal Determiners

Cardinal determiners show exact number and answer the question “how many?”. They include one, two, three, and so on. Ordinal determiners show order or position and answer the question “which one in order?”. They include first, second, third, and so on. These determiners are often used in instructions, dates, ranks, and sequences.

Two boys were absent.

She has three notebooks.

He won the first prize.

This is my second attempt.

We live on the third floor.

Distributive determiners

Distributive determiners refer to members of a group individually or in small parts. Common distributive determiners include each, every, either, and neither. ‘Each’ focuses on individuals, while ‘every’ refers to all members as a whole. Either and neither are generally used for two choices or two items. These determiners help create clear meaning in rules and instructions.

Each student must submit the form.

Every child needs care.

Either option is acceptable.

Neither answer is correct.

Each day brings new learning.

Interrogatives determiners

Interrogative determiners are used to ask questions and come before nouns. They include which, what, and whose. They help identify exactly which item or person is being asked about. They differ from interrogative pronouns because determiners are followed by a noun. These are commonly tested in sentence correction and question formation.

Which book do you want?

What time is the meeting?

Whose bag is this?



Which route is shorter?

What colour dress will you wear?

when w word is determiners and when not.

A 'wh-' word like what, which, or whose works as a determiner when it is followed by a noun. It works as a pronoun when it stands alone and replaces a noun. In questions, the same word can change its role depending on sentence structure. To identify it, check whether a noun immediately follows the word. This distinction helps in editing and grammar-based objective questions.

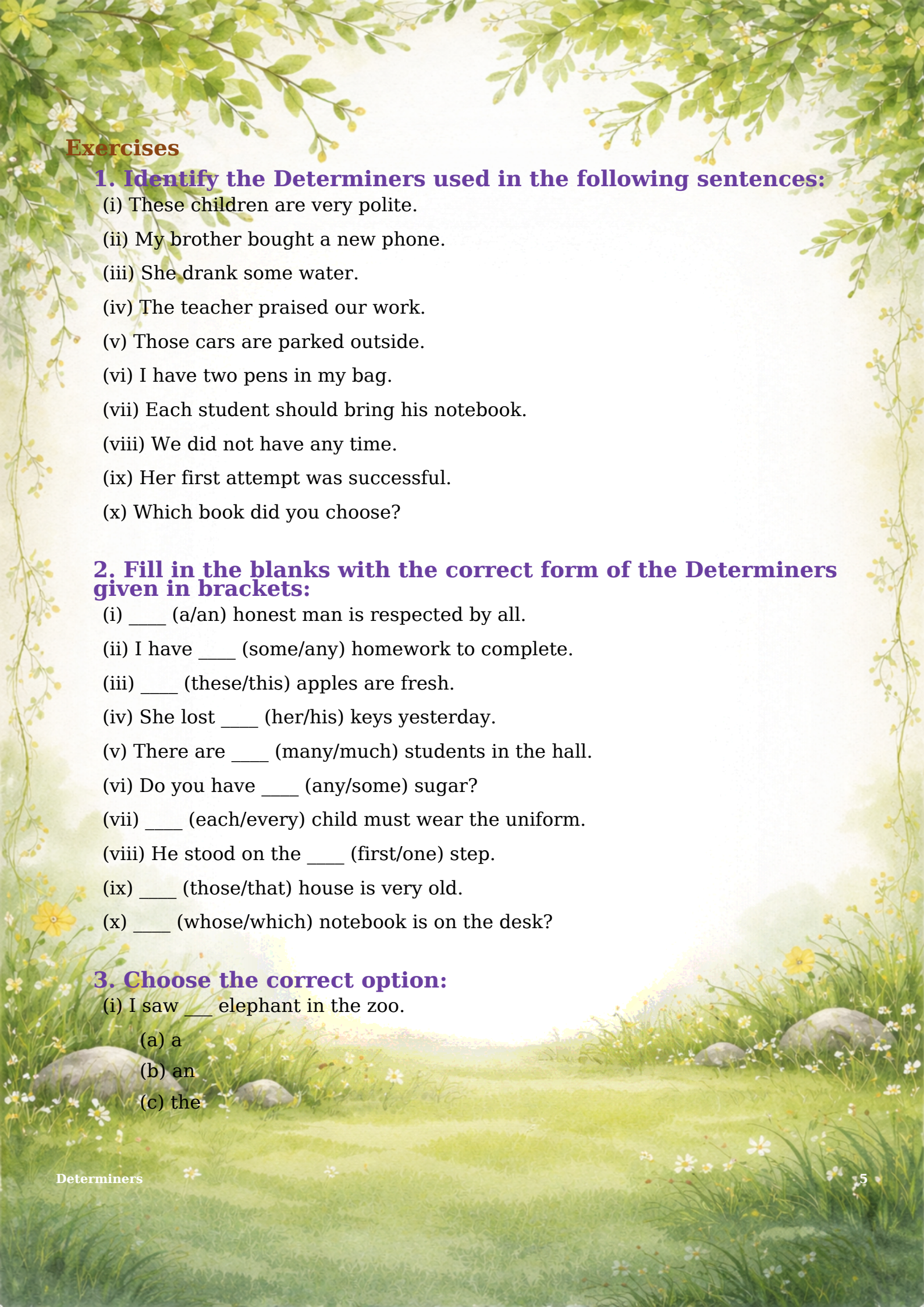
Which pen is yours? (determiner: 'pen' follows)

Which is yours? (pronoun: no noun follows)

What answer did you write? (determiner: 'answer' follows)

What did you write? (pronoun: no noun follows)

Whose notebook is missing? (determiner: 'notebook' follows)



Exercises

1. Identify the Determiners used in the following sentences:

- (i) These children are very polite.
- (ii) My brother bought a new phone.
- (iii) She drank some water.
- (iv) The teacher praised our work.
- (v) Those cars are parked outside.
- (vi) I have two pens in my bag.
- (vii) Each student should bring his notebook.
- (viii) We did not have any time.
- (ix) Her first attempt was successful.
- (x) Which book did you choose?

2. Fill in the blanks with the correct form of the Determiners given in brackets:

- (i) ____ (a/an) honest man is respected by all.
- (ii) I have ____ (some/any) homework to complete.
- (iii) ____ (these/this) apples are fresh.
- (iv) She lost ____ (her/his) keys yesterday.
- (v) There are ____ (many/much) students in the hall.
- (vi) Do you have ____ (any/some) sugar?
- (vii) ____ (each/every) child must wear the uniform.
- (viii) He stood on the ____ (first/one) step.
- (ix) ____ (those/that) house is very old.
- (x) ____ (whose/which) notebook is on the desk?

3. Choose the correct option:

- (i) I saw ____ elephant in the zoo.
 - (a) a
 - (b) an
 - (c) the

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- (d) no article
- (ii) She has ___ friends in this city.
- (a) much
- (b) many
- (c) a
- (d) the
- (iii) ___ students must submit the form today.
- (a) Each
- (b) Much
- (c) An
- (d) Whose
- (iv) Is there ___ milk left?
- (a) many
- (b) any
- (c) these
- (d) those
- (v) ___ book is on the table?
- (a) Which
- (b) Any
- (c) Few
- (d) Much
- (vi) He won the ___ prize in the competition.
- (a) two
- (b) second
- (c) many
- (d) such
- (vii) ___ my parents are coming to the meeting.
- (a) Both
- (b) Much
- (c) An
- (d) Whose
- (viii) I don't have ___ time to waste.

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- (a) many
 - (b) much
 - (c) two
 - (d) these

4. Match the following:

List A

- 1. Articles
- 2. Possessive
- 3. Demonstrative
- 4. Quantifiers
- 5. Distributive

List B

- A. this/that/these/those
- B. my/your/his/her
- C. a/an/the
- D. some/many/much
- E. each/every/either/neither

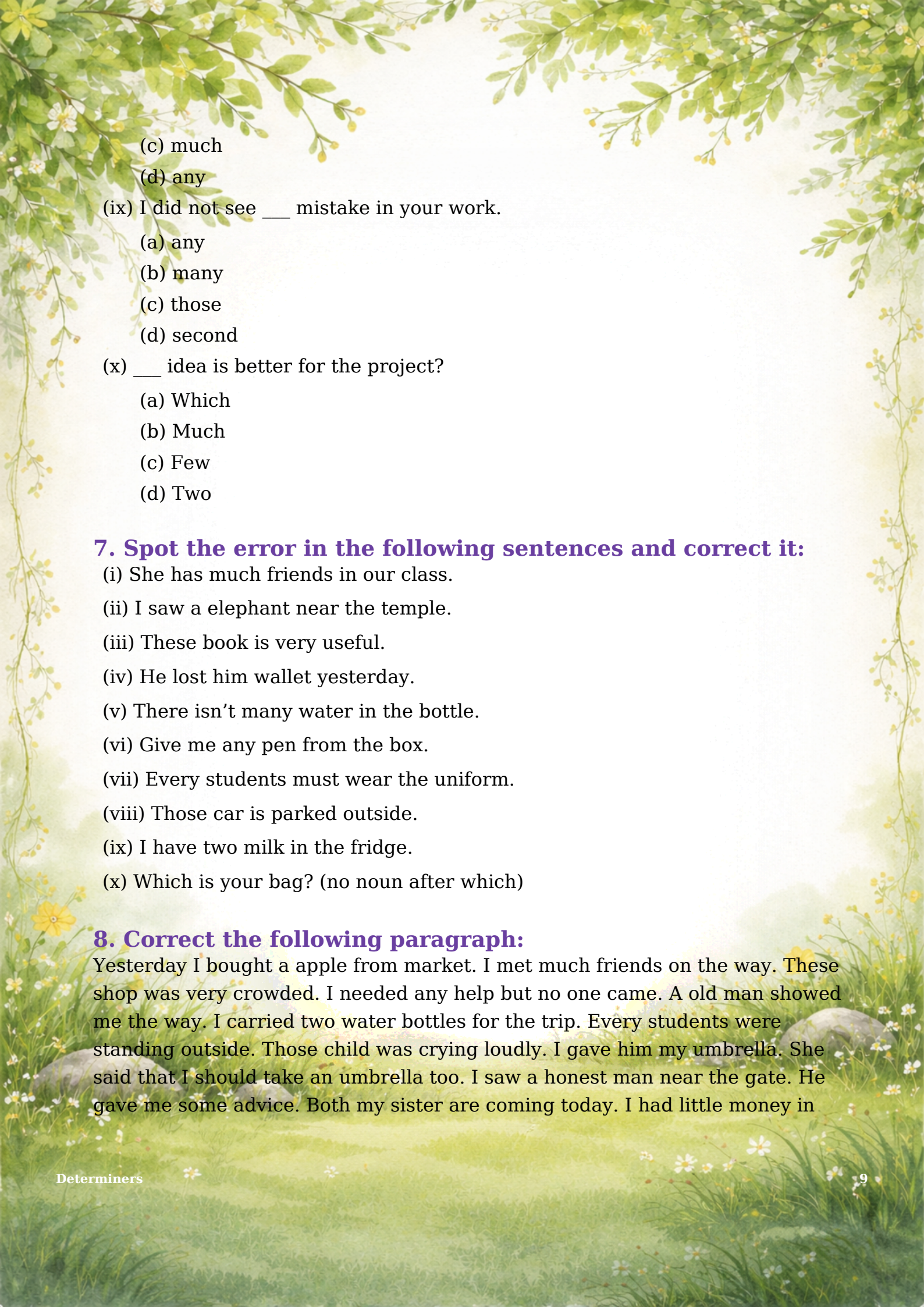
5. Identify the type of Determiners used:

- (i) My sister is a doctor.
- (ii) Those students are waiting outside.
- (iii) I have some questions to ask.
- (iv) Each player received a medal.
- (v) He came first in the race.
- (vi) Both the answers are correct.
- (vii) We don't have any water.
- (viii) Which chapter are you reading?
- (ix) The cat is sleeping.
- (x) She has three notebooks.

6. Multiple choice questions:

- (i) She bought ___ umbrella because it was raining.
 - (a) a
 - (b) an
 - (c) the
 - (d) some
- (ii) There are ___ chairs in the room.

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- (a) much
(b) many
(c) any
(d) this
- (iii) ___ of the two roads is shorter.
(a) Either
(b) Every
(c) Much
(d) Whose
- (iv) I have ___ little patience today.
(a) too
(b) many
(c) these
(d) second
- (v) ___ student was given a badge.
(a) Each
(b) Any
(c) An
(d) Much
- (vi) He drank ___ water after the run.
(a) many
(b) much
(c) those
(d) two
- (vii) ___ your brother coming today?
(a) Is
(b) Are
(c) Was
(d) Were
- (viii) She stood in the ___ row.
(a) third
(b) three

- 
- (c) much
(d) any
- (ix) I did not see ____ mistake in your work.
(a) any
(b) many
(c) those
(d) second
- (x) ____ idea is better for the project?
(a) Which
(b) Much
(c) Few
(d) Two

7. Spot the error in the following sentences and correct it:

- (i) She has much friends in our class.
(ii) I saw a elephant near the temple.
(iii) These book is very useful.
(iv) He lost him wallet yesterday.
(v) There isn't many water in the bottle.
(vi) Give me any pen from the box.
(vii) Every students must wear the uniform.
(viii) Those car is parked outside.
(ix) I have two milk in the fridge.
(x) Which is your bag? (no noun after which)

8. Correct the following paragraph:

Yesterday I bought a apple from market. I met much friends on the way. These shop was very crowded. I needed any help but no one came. A old man showed me the way. I carried two water bottles for the trip. Every students were standing outside. Those child was crying loudly. I gave him my umbrella. She said that I should take an umbrella too. I saw a honest man near the gate. He gave me some advice. Both my sister are coming today. I had little money in



pocket. I bought the second book from stall. Which pen is missing from your box? Which is missing from your box? There was many noise in street. I returned to the home late. This incident taught me a lesson.



Answer Sheet

1. Identify the Determiners:

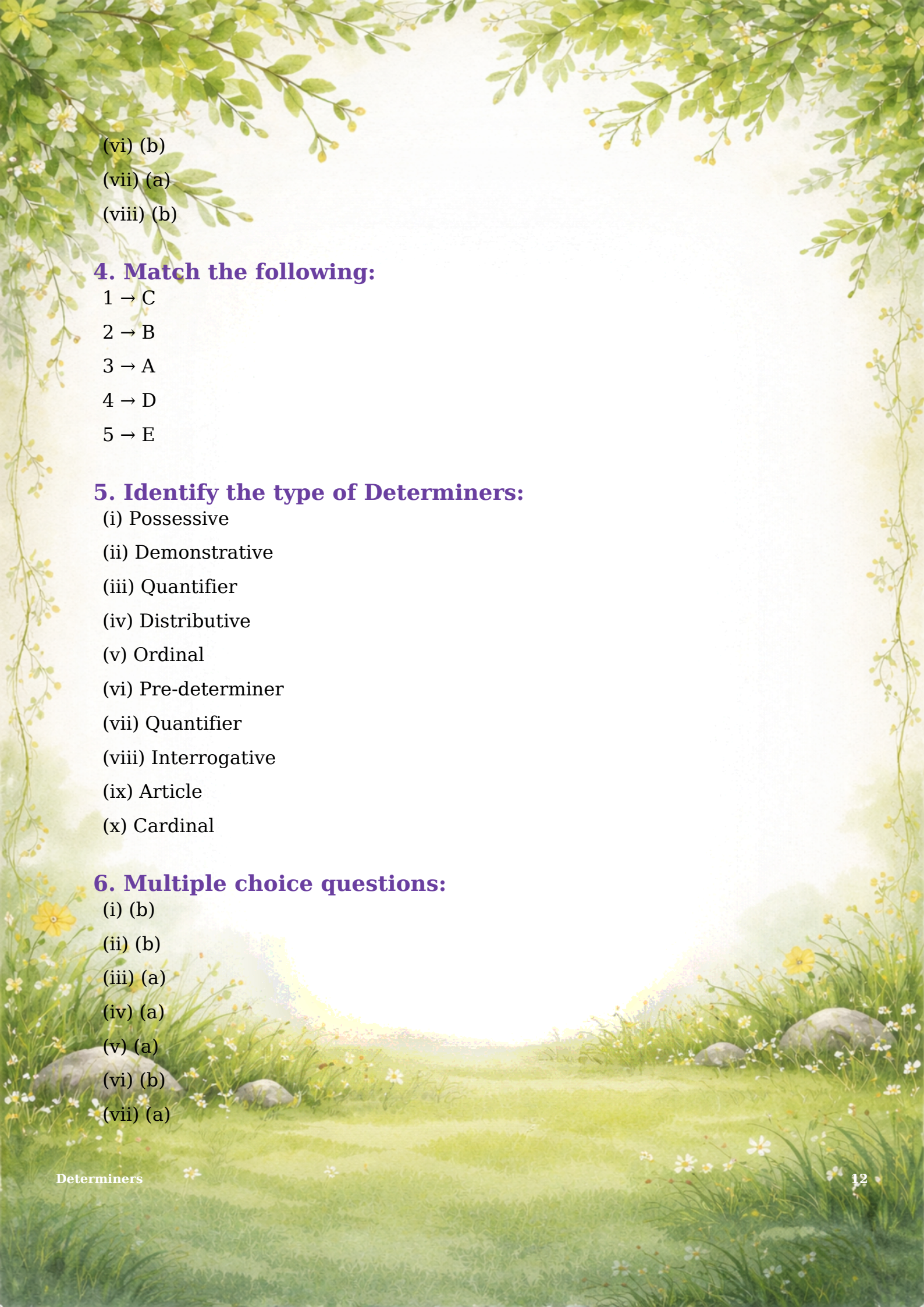
- (i) These
- (ii) My, a
- (iii) some
- (iv) The, our
- (v) Those
- (vi) two, my
- (vii) Each, his
- (viii) any
- (ix) Her, first
- (x) Which

2. Fill in the blanks:

- (i) an
- (ii) some
- (iii) these
- (iv) her
- (v) many
- (vi) any
- (vii) every
- (viii) first
- (ix) that
- (x) whose

3. Choose the correct option:

- (i) (b)
- (ii) (b)
- (iii) (a)
- (iv) (b)
- (v) (a)

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- (vi) (b)
(vii) (a)
(viii) (b)

4. Match the following:

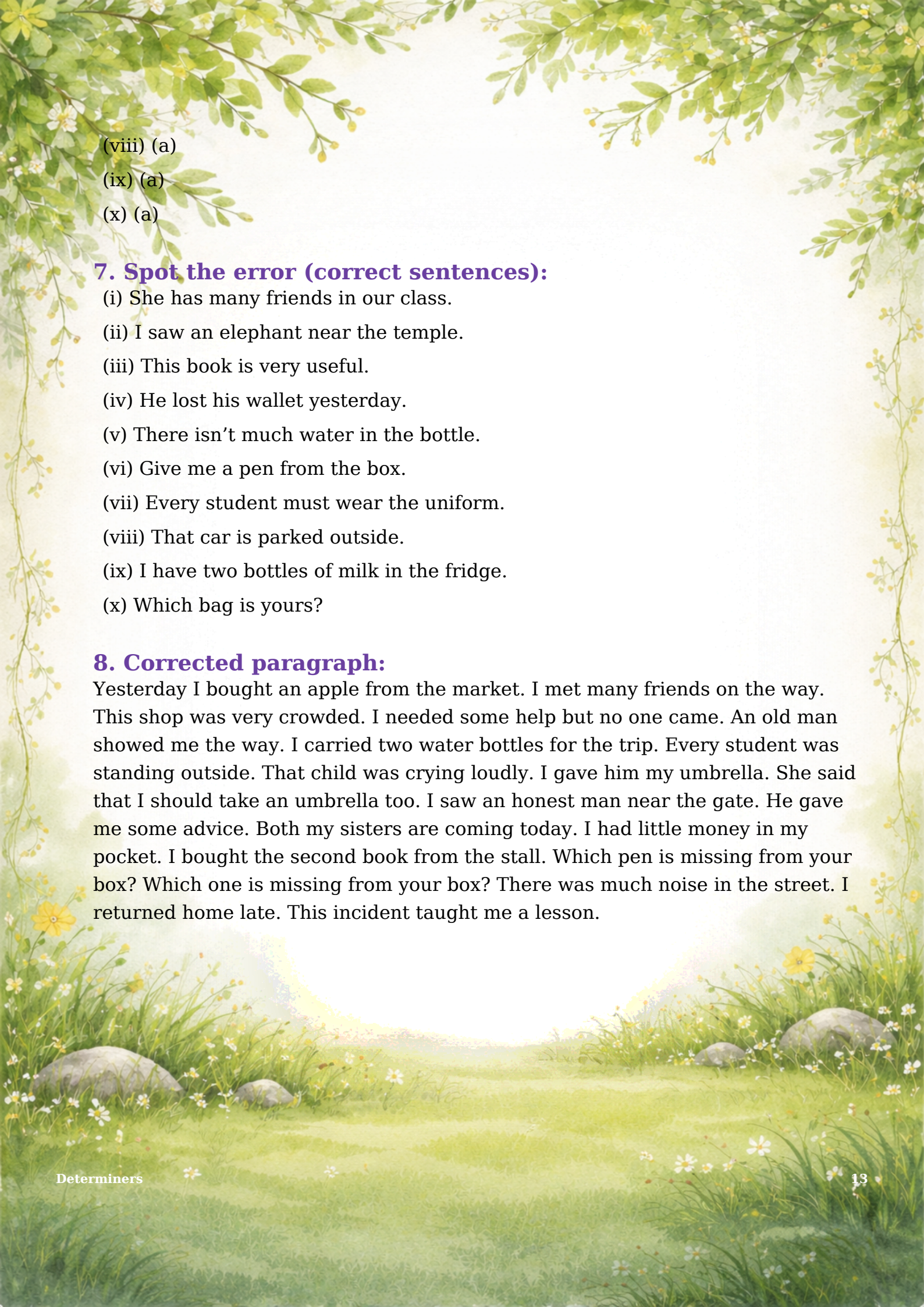
- 1 → C
2 → B
3 → A
4 → D
5 → E

5. Identify the type of Determiners:

- (i) Possessive
(ii) Demonstrative
(iii) Quantifier
(iv) Distributive
(v) Ordinal
(vi) Pre-determiner
(vii) Quantifier
(viii) Interrogative
(ix) Article
(x) Cardinal

6. Multiple choice questions:

- (i) (b)
(ii) (b)
(iii) (a)
(iv) (a)
(v) (a)
(vi) (b)
(vii) (a)



(viii) (a)

(ix) (a)

(x) (a)

7. Spot the error (correct sentences):

- (i) She has many friends in our class.
- (ii) I saw an elephant near the temple.
- (iii) This book is very useful.
- (iv) He lost his wallet yesterday.
- (v) There isn't much water in the bottle.
- (vi) Give me a pen from the box.
- (vii) Every student must wear the uniform.
- (viii) That car is parked outside.
- (ix) I have two bottles of milk in the fridge.
- (x) Which bag is yours?

8. Corrected paragraph:

Yesterday I bought an apple from the market. I met many friends on the way. This shop was very crowded. I needed some help but no one came. An old man showed me the way. I carried two water bottles for the trip. Every student was standing outside. That child was crying loudly. I gave him my umbrella. She said that I should take an umbrella too. I saw an honest man near the gate. He gave me some advice. Both my sisters are coming today. I had little money in my pocket. I bought the second book from the stall. Which pen is missing from your box? Which one is missing from your box? There was much noise in the street. I returned home late. This incident taught me a lesson.